

The Boston Globe

Serving our community since 1872

SATURDAY, DECEMBER 21, 2024

State board suspends Boston police captain

Danilecki, subject of multiple complaints over years, gets 5 days

By Nick Stoico
GLOBE STAFF

The Massachusetts police oversight board has suspended a Boston police captain for five days for his role in a 2019 confrontation in Dorchester in which he was accused of knocking a man to the ground, in a rare intervention by the state government in a local police disciplinary matter.

The Peace Officer Standards and Training Commission on Friday an-

nounced its ruling against Captain John Danilecki, who has faced numerous internal affairs complaints over his 38-year career with the Boston Police Department. Danilecki agreed to have his law enforcement certification suspended for five days, which began Thursday, according to the commission.

The POST Commission said the suspension was based on the Dorchester incident as well as Danilecki's "repeated sustained internal

affairs complaints."

Danilecki, who has been nicknamed "Pepper Jack" by protesters who have singled him out for his excessive use of pepper spray during demonstrations, has been the subject of at least 21 internal affairs cases in his career, though he was cleared by Boston police in the majority of them, the Globe reported last year.

The POST Commission was created after the 2020 reckoning over

police abuses following the killing of George Floyd by Minneapolis police, as well as other similarly shocking incidents of police abuse.

Under the law that created the commission, the agency has to certify local police officers for duty based on physical and psychological standards, as well as training requirements, and certifications must be renewed every three years. So far, it's certified more than 20,000 officers, decertified 39, and suspended 57 others as of November, according to

CAPTAIN, Page A10

House says no to shutdown, Trump

Bill approved without debt measure he demanded

By Carl Hulse, Maya C. Miller, and Catie Edmondson
NEW YORK TIMES

WASHINGTON — The House on Friday approved legislation to avert a federal shutdown that was just hours away, with lawmakers extending funding into mid-March and approving \$100 billion in disaster relief for parts of the nation still reeling from storms. The Senate was expected to quickly follow suit.

The House vote came after Republicans stripped out a provision demanded by President-elect Donald Trump to suspend the federal debt limit and spare him the usually politically charged task of doing so when he takes office. But that demand sparked a revolt by dozens of Republicans on Thursday and led to a major defeat on the House floor.

The measure that passed Friday, by a vote of 366-34, must still be approved by the Senate and sent to President Biden to keep dollars flowing to federal agencies. Otherwise, funding will lapse at 12:01 a.m. Saturday. All 34 "no" votes were from Republicans; one Democrat, Representative Jasmine Crockett of Texas, voted "present."

Senator Chuck Schumer, Democrat of New York and the majority leader, said he expected the Senate to act quickly on the legislation.

"Though this bill does not include everything Democrats fought for, there are major victories in this bill for American families," Schumer said, citing "emergency aid for communities battered by

SHUTDOWN, Page A7

FLAKE NEWS



SUZANNE KREITER/GLOBE STAFF

It's getting to be an unusual sight — snow in Boston — but there it was Friday, covering the Public Garden (above) and piling up a few inches in parts of the region. A cold weekend is likely to keep things looking wintry for the holidays. **B4.**

A federal judge ruled against North End restaurant owners who have battled the Wu administration over outdoor dining restrictions. **B1.**

A car plowed into a busy outdoor Christmas market in the eastern German city of Magdeburg, killing at least two people. **A5.**



ALEX BABENKO/ASSOCIATED PRESS

KYIV TARGETED — A woman warmed her dog as she walked through a destroyed area after a recent Russian attack. On Friday, Russia unleashed a barrage of missiles, killing at least one person and injuring 12. **A4.**

Second Read trial could be even costlier for the state

By Sean Cotter and Laura Crimaldi
GLOBE STAFF

DEDHAM — Spectators tuned in at home, or during work. Some traveled from around the world to attend in person. Through hundreds of hours of testimony in the Karen Read murder trial, observers became versed in the rhythms of a courtroom.

Few cases in recent years have captivated so many as the trial of Read, a Mansfield woman accused of killing her

boyfriend, Boston police officer John O'Keefe, by hitting him with her SUV after a night of heavy drinking.

This trial likely cost the state — and thus taxpayers — about \$700,000, an unusual sum that could rise to \$750,000 for a second trial with a new special prosecutor scheduled for the spring, according to a Globe analysis of public records.

The trial that began in April included 29 days of testimony, nearly three times

READ, Page A10

Even when times are tough, Toys for Tots feels the magic

By Billy Baker
GLOBE STAFF

Marydith Tuitt stands inside a cavernous function room at the Boston Convention and Exhibition Center, surrounded by mountains of black trash bags — each filled with 10 toys. But she is staring at a problem.

A piece of paper taped to a wall reads "Boys 0-3," but beneath the sign the space is empty. There are no black trash bags. There are — for the moment

— no gifts left for the youngest boys.

"This is when we work off fate," Tuitt said. "This is when we hope for a Christmas miracle to come in the door, or those babies aren't going to get anything."

For the past decade, Tuitt has volunteered for the Greater Boston chapter of Toys for Tots, the organization, founded by the Marine Corps Reserve in 1947, that has for generations distributed

TOYS, Page A7

By Sam Brodey
GLOBE STAFF

WASHINGTON — As President Biden and first lady Jill Biden participated in their tradition of reading " 'Twas the Night Before Christmas" to patients and families at Children's National Hospital on Friday, a few miles away at the Capitol, 'twas the eve of something else.

The government he is in charge of was teetering on the verge of a shutdown.

And while many creatures were stirring over this development — President-elect Donald Trump chief among them — Biden was not.

The president kept quietly to the sidelines as Trump and his ally Elon Musk torpedoed a bipartisan deal to fund the government and other priorities days before the deadline. As House Speaker Mike Johnson began scrambling on Wednesday for a last-minute solution that could pass his chamber, the Democratic-controlled Senate, and satisfy Trump, the man with actual veto power over any bill did not make any public statements about the situation.

Between the Capitol Hill drama and the angry missives from Mar-a-Lago and Musk posts on X, the GOP infighting nearly drowned out something significant: that Biden's disengagement, as much as anything, was a symbolic marker of the close of his time in power, and the dawn of Trump's.

Beyond his public silence, no indication emerged that Biden was aggressively working be-

BIDEN, Page A6

VOL. 306, NO. 174

*

Suggested retail price
\$4.00

Bitter up

Saturday: Clearing, windy.
High 29-34. Low 12-17.

Sunday: Very cold.
High 18-23. Low 11-16.

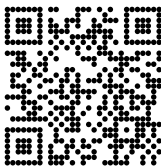
Sunrise: 7:10 Sunset: 4:15

Weather and Comics, D4-5.



4 DAYS LEFT TO DONATE

ON THE SHORTEST DAY OF THE YEAR, HELP GLOBE SANTA MAKE IT THE BRIGHTEST FOR KIDS IN NEED.



DONATE
VIA VENMO



DONATE AT
GLOBESANTA.ORG



Boston Globe
FOUNDATION

